

When looking to build new friendships, we love Meetup groups for shared interests like reading or crafting, fitness classes, running and cycling groups, faith communities, and volunteer opportunities. They all offer both an outlet for interests and fill in the gaps where we may be lacking relationally. They also give us the opportunity to *be* the kind of friend we want to have. To ask ourselves, “How am I showing up in relationships?” “How are others experiencing me?” “What am I glad to offer in friendships and where can I improve?” Making the small changes that get you closer to the person you want to be toward others is what will create long-lasting friendships where you want them most.

All this self-understanding, boundary setting, and holding loosely allows the organism of community to grow and become a strong place of safety, support, and intentional spending. And we can find ourselves rich in relationships.

When we value others without harming ourselves, we can experience a wealth of goodness within our communities. We can invite and engage others into our values-based spending journey both explicitly and implicitly.

I’m sure glad Jen and I both went out on a limb that one day in April, choosing community even when it didn’t feel convenient. That meeting has led to knowledge and support that has absolutely changed the trajectory of my life for the better. Just this one friendship has provided something in a relationship I was previously lacking—safety to chat about financial things—and made space for thousands of others to find their people, feel seen, and be reminded they’re not alone in this journey.

Your friends and surrounding community can be your biggest cheerleaders and helpers in living out your values. They can be the ones to join you, encourage you, and remind you of the great things you want to do with your life and money. It starts with you recognizing what those great things are, communicating it, sticking with it, and cultivating that community that makes it all possible.